

ZIXIN WANG

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Born 5 December 1997 (28 years old)
Chinese Citizen

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics , London School of Economics (LSE) Fields: Political Economy, Economic History	2022–2027 (expected)
M.Res. in Economics (Merit), LSE	2020–2022
M.Sc. in Econometrics and Mathematical Economics (Distinction), LSE	2019–2020
B.Sc. in Financial Mathematics (First Class Honours), University of Liverpool (2+2 joint programme: first two years at Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, Suzhou)	2015–2019

REFERENCES

Ronny Razin
Professor, LSE

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Kent Deng
Professor, LSE

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Hao Chen
Assistant Professor,
University of Twente
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JOB MARKET PAPER

“Losing Access to Canton: Trade Shock and Social Conflict in Qing China”

Abstract: Does losing access to an established trade route stabilize or destabilize society? Economic theory is ambiguous. I examine the 1842 Treaty of Nanjing, which ended the Canton System and opened four new coastal treaty ports, collapsing demand for transport labor along the old inland routes. Using an original county-year panel of 427 counties from 1820 to 1860, I find that counties on the pre-1842 Canton routes experienced a large rise in rebellion probability after the treaty. Counties in the hinterland of Shanghai, which gained trade access, show no comparable rise. This asymmetry, together with effects concentrated in counties that served as transit hubs, points to an opportunity cost channel through displaced transport workers rather than rapacity. Disaggregating conflict by motive, the effect holds for both anti-social and anti-state violence, and route counties became substantially more susceptible to Taiping mobilization after 1851.

WORKING PAPERS

- “Operational AI Embedding and Green Innovation: When Rapid Adaptation Matters”

With Wei Zhao, Mahak Sharma, and Hao Chen

Submitted to *Technovation*

We introduce disclosed AI-enabled execution capability (AEC), a text-based measure of whether

firms embed AI in operational and governance workflows rather than merely report its use. Using a panel of Chinese A-share listed firms (2020–2025), we find that the within-firm link between AEC and subsequent green invention patenting is small on average but substantially stronger when operating conditions demand rapid adaptation.

- **“Physics-Informed Modeling of Salinity-Gradient Power Generation and Operating Conditions”**

With Wei Zhao and Hao Chen

Submitted to *Renewable Energy*

We develop a physics-informed model of salinity-gradient power that represents the feed and draw channels separately and couples them through membrane transport. Validated against finite-element simulations, it reproduces the pressure-dependent power maximum and predicts a full field in a fraction of a second, enabling rapid screening of operating conditions before high-fidelity simulation.

SEMINAR AND CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026: The 9th Asian Historical Economics Conference (upcoming, NUS), The 12th Symposium on Quantitative History (Wuhan, China), Warwick–LSE Political Economy Conference, Chinese Economy Research Group, LSE PSPE WIP Seminar, LSE Speech Seminar

AWARDS AND RESEARCH GRANTS

STICERD Research Grant (No. 109824), London School of Economics £5,000, 2023

“Selection or Shaping? Cohort Effects, Experience, and Politicians’ Support for Military Intervention”
(with Giorgio Ravalli and Peter Ward-Griffin)

LSE Economics Teaching Bonus Award 2023, 2024, 2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Assistant, LSE

- EC1A3: Microeconomics I (B.Sc.) 2022–2026
- EC1B3: Macroeconomics I (B.Sc.) 2022–2026

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Macro Intern, Founder Securities Co. Feb 2021–Aug 2021

Research Assistant, Bank of China (Shanghai Branch) Sep 2020–Dec 2020

COMPUTER SKILLS

Programming: MATLAB, Python, Stata, R

GIS: ArcGIS (QGIS)

Typographic: L^AT_EX

LANGUAGES

Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent)

Last update: October 2026